
A GUIDE FROM AMY GREEN

The Nine Seasons

*A therapist's map of a
woman's inner life.*

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START HERE

It's never just hormones.

In more than a decade as a therapist, I kept hearing the same words spoken to women: **"It's just hormones." "It's just stress." "It's just a phase."**

But the truth was always bigger — and always about context. The same symptoms — the anxiety, the flatness, the rage, the fog — mean completely different things depending on the season a woman is in. Postpartum exhaustion is not perimenopausal grief. The dread of infertility is not the dread of an empty nest. Read the symptom without the season, and you miss the woman.

Context isn't a side note. It's the whole story.

So I started mapping it — the nine seasons I've spent my career helping women move through. Not diagnoses. Not stages you pass and finish. **Seasons you move through, return to, and sometimes live in more than one at once.**

This is that map. Read it for yourself, or for a woman you love. See if you can find the season you're in.

The Nine Seasons

1

The Awakening

Adolescence and coming of age. The body changing faster than the mind can hold it — first anxiety, first depression, an identity forming under enormous pressure. The season we too often call "just being a teenager."

2

The Striving

Young adulthood. Ambition, independence, building a life and a self. The achievement is visible; the weight underneath it — the perfectionism, the loneliness, the pressure to have it figured out — usually isn't.

3

The Wait

Trying to conceive, fertility struggles, infertility, and pregnancy loss. A grief that's often invisible and unspoken — mourning something you never got to hold, month after month.

4

Expecting

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Pregnancy. The mental health of the person — not just the pregnancy. The anxiety and depression that arrive with the wanted, celebrated thing, and go unspoken because you're "supposed to be happy."

5

Becoming

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Matrescence and the postpartum year. The identity earthquake of new motherhood — the making of a mother, and the grief for the woman she was before. One of the most underestimated seasons of all.

The Nine Seasons

6

The Juggle

Active motherhood and career at once. The mental load, the disappearing self, the midlife squeeze of caring for children and aging parents. Exhaustion mistaken for who she now is.

7

The Shift

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Perimenopause and menopause. The season most casually dismissed as "just hormones" — when the mood changes, the sleeplessness, and the rage are real, physiological, and treatable, not a personality flaw.

8

Brave

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Illness, diagnosis, treatment, and caregiving. Mental health when the body is in crisis — the fear, the loss of control, the identity upheaval that a cancer or chronic illness brings alongside the physical fight.

9

The Reckoning

Aging, grief, the empty nest, loss, and reinvention. The wisdom seasons — where a woman meets who she's become, mourns what's gone, and decides what comes next.

*Wherever you are — you're not broken.
You're in a season. And every season deserves
care.*

KEEP GOING

If this named something for you, come read the rest.

Every week I write about these seasons — honestly, clinically, and from the inside. If *The Nine Seasons* gave you language for where you are, the newsletter is where the fuller stories live.

Read the newsletter → itsneverjustthehormones.substack.com

— *Amy*

Amy Green is a licensed clinical social worker (LCSW), a certified perinatal mental health specialist (PMH-C), and the founder of Mamaya Health. This guide is for education and reflection and is not medical or mental health advice. If you're in crisis, call or text 988 (U.S.).